

The Level Ladder, key and diagnosis

WHAT THIS IS MEASURING

Six parts, one per unit of New Close-up B1 Split A. The class has not studied any of it yet, so a low total is expected and is not the point. Each part is four grammar items they could plausibly have met at school and two vocabulary items from the unit's own word list. The grammar scores tell you what you can move through quickly. The vocabulary scores are only a rough signal, since the book's glossary is new to them.

Answer key, 36 marks

	ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS		ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS
1	works	1	present simple, habit	19	which	4	defining relative, thing
2	is sleeping	1	present continuous, now	20	whose	4	possessive relative
3	like	1	stative verb, not continuous	21	which	4	non-defining relative
4	is taking	1	continuous, temporary	22	as soon as	4	time clause, present for future
5	architect	1	jobs	23	leather	4	materials
6	reliable	1	personality adjectives	24	receipt	4	shopping
7	ate	2	past simple, irregular	25	are going to	5	be going to, decided plan
8	was cooking	2	past continuous, interrupted	26	I'll	5	will, spontaneous offer
9	was chopping	2	two past continuous actions	27	is going to	5	going to, present evidence
10	used to	2	used to, past habit	28	am seeing	5	present continuous, arrangement
11	sour	2	taste adjectives	29	wardrobe	5	household objects
12	pour	2	cooking verbs	30	move	5	home expressions
13	have / been	3	present perfect, never	31	boils	6	zero conditional
14	have lived	3	present perfect with since	32	wins	6	first conditional
15	have been looking	3	present perfect continuous	33	unless	6	unless
16	an	3	articles	34	had	6	second conditional
17	glacier	3	geographical features	35	helmet	6	sports equipment
18	renewable	3	climate change	36	coach	6	sports people

Marks that are worth a second look. Q26 and Q27 both look like futures but split on offer versus evidence, and Q28 is an arrangement, so a student who puts *will* in all three has one rule, not three. Q13 and Q14 separate present perfect from past simple, which is the single most common Spanish-speaker error in this book. Q34 is the only question above the Split A syllabus, since second conditional appears at the end of Unit 6, so treat it as a bonus rather than a gap.

Who knows what

Marks by unit, 6 per unit

UNIT	STUDENT 1	STUDENT 2	STUDENT 3	STUDENT 4	STUDENT 5
Name					
1 Perfect for the job (Q1 to 6)					
2 Delicious! (Q7 to 12)					
3 It's natural (Q13 to 18)					
4 That's the fashion (Q19 to 24)					
5 Where we live (Q25 to 30)					
6 Go for it! (Q31 to 36)					
TOTAL / 36					
Wrote the extra message?					

Reading a single unit column

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THAT UNIT	WHAT TO DO
5 or 6	They already have the grammar. The unit will be revision plus new vocabulary.	Move fast through the grammar pages, spend the time on the exam task and the speaking.
3 or 4	Partly there, usually the form but not the choice between two tenses.	Teach normally. Add one contrast drill on the pair they confused.
0 to 2	New. Do not assume any of it.	Budget a full extra session. Start from meaning, not from the rule.

Reading the total

/ 36	WHERE THEY ARE
28 to 36	Well above where the book starts. They will need extension work, or the class will bore them. Use the Extra Tasks Extension sheets in the source pack.
20 to 27	Solid B1 entry. The book is correctly pitched for them.
12 to 19	A2 plus, which is normal for the start of 3 ^o ESO. The book will stretch them, which is the point.
0 to 11	Below the book's entry point. Check whether they were guessing at random, then plan A2 consolidation alongside Unit 1.

After marking, answer these three

Which unit scored lowest across the whole class?	
Which student is furthest ahead, and what will you give them?	
Which student is furthest behind, and what is the first thing to fix?	

Timing. Allow 25 to 30 minutes for the 36 questions and 10 for the extra message. That leaves roughly 45 minutes of the 90 minute session for the Unit 1 opener, which starts on page 5 with the haenyeo diver photo. Teacher's book notes are at PDF page 20 of *NewCloseUp_B1_TeachersBook_AllUnits.md*.